

The Brave Rabbit's Big Choice

Barnaby was a very brave rabbit. He lived in a cozy burrow under a tall oak tree. Barnaby wore a bright blue cape every day. He liked to jump over big rocks. He liked to explore the dark woods. Everyone in the meadow said Barnaby was the bravest rabbit of all.

One sunny morning, Barnaby went to visit his friend, Pip. Pip was a small red squirrel. Pip had something very special. It was a shiny blue glass marble.

"This is my favorite treasure," Pip said. "Please watch it while I go get us some nuts."

Pip put the marble on a soft green leaf. Then, he scurried up a tree. Barnaby looked at the marble. It sparkled like the sky. He wanted to see how it felt. Barnaby picked it up with his paws.

Suddenly, the marble slipped! It hit a stone with a loud *clack*. Barnaby looked closely. Oh no! The marble had a big crack right down the middle. Barnaby's heart began to beat very fast. He felt a heavy feeling in his tummy.

Decision Point 1:

- * **Option A:** Hide the cracked marble under a big leaf so Pip does not see it.
- * **Option B:** Leave the marble on the leaf and wait for Pip to come back.

(If the reader chooses Option A: Barnaby hides the marble)

Barnaby pushed the marble under a dusty leaf. He sat on his paws. He tried to look happy. Pip came back with three large acorns.

"Where is my marble?" Pip asked.

Barnaby's ears drooped. He felt very bad inside. He knew he was being a "scaredy-rabbit," not a brave one.

(If the reader chooses Option B: Barnaby waits for Pip)

Barnaby stood by the marble. He wanted to run away and hide. But he stayed right there. Pip came back with three large acorns.

"What happened to my marble?" Pip asked.

Barnaby's paws shook. He knew telling the truth was harder than jumping over rocks.

****Decision Point 2:****

* ****Option A:**** Tell Pip, "I don't know what happened. Maybe a bird hit it!"

* ****Option B:**** Tell Pip, "I am so sorry. I broke it when I picked it up."

****The Resolution****

Barnaby looked at Pip. He took a deep breath.

"I am sorry, Pip," Barnaby said. "I wanted to touch it. I dropped it and it broke. I was not being careful."

Barnaby waited. He thought Pip would be very angry. Pip looked at his cracked marble. He looked sad for a moment. Then, Pip looked at Barnaby and smiled a little bit.

"Thank you for telling me the truth," Pip said. "I am sad about the marble. But I am happy you are my friend. You didn't try to trick me."

As soon as Barnaby told the truth, the heavy feeling in his tummy went away. He felt light and happy again. He realized something very important. Being brave is not just

about jumping over rocks. Being brave means telling the truth, even when you are scared.

Barnaby and Pip spent the rest of the day playing tag. Barnaby still wore his blue cape. He was the bravest rabbit in the meadow. And now, he was the most honest rabbit, too.

Illustration Prompts

1. ****The Accident:**** A high-detail, Pixar-style 3D render of Barnaby the rabbit. He has soft brown fur and large, expressive eyes. He is wearing a small, vibrant blue cape. He is looking down at a cracked blue glass marble on a forest floor. The lighting is dappled sunlight through leaves. His face shows a mix of shock and worry.
2. ****The Heavy Feeling:**** A close-up of Barnaby sitting near a large oak tree. The colors are slightly cooler and muted. Barnaby's ears are drooping low. He is clutching his tummy with his paws. His expression shows guilt and internal conflict. The background is a soft-focus meadow with colorful wildflowers.
3. ****The Moral Victory:**** A warm, glowing sunset scene in the meadow. Barnaby and Pip the squirrel are high-fiving (paw-to-paw). Barnaby looks proud and happy with his chest puffed out. Pip is smiling warmly. The style is cinematic with rich textures on the fur and grass.

Narration Script

****(Warm, gentle tone)****

"Barnaby was a very brave rabbit. He lived in a cozy burrow under a tall oak tree. Barnaby wore a bright blue cape every day. One morning, he visited his friend, Pip the squirrel. Pip had a beautiful, shiny blue marble. He asked Barnaby to watch it.

****(Slightly concerned tone)****

But when Barnaby picked it up, it slipped! **Clack!** The marble cracked. Barnaby felt a heavy weight in his tummy. Should he hide the mistake, or stay and face it?

****(Encouraging tone)****

When Pip returned, Barnaby had a choice to make. He could tell a story, or he could tell the truth. Barnaby took a deep breath. He told Pip exactly what happened. He said he was sorry.

****(Bright, happy tone)****

The heavy feeling in Barnaby's tummy disappeared. Pip was happy that Barnaby was honest. Barnaby learned that the bravest thing you can ever do is tell the truth."

****Background Music Description****

* ****Instrumental Tone:**** Acoustic and whimsical.

* ****Instrumentation:**** A light acoustic guitar melody as the base, accompanied by a soft flute for Barnaby's movements. A gentle glockenspiel (bell sound) plays when the marble sparkles.

* ****Mood Shift:**** The music starts bright and bouncy. When the marble breaks, the melody shifts to a lower, slower cello or minor piano chord to show Barnaby's worry. As he tells the truth, the music builds back up into a swelling, cheerful orchestral folk tune to celebrate his honesty.